🛡️ The 'Stay Safe Online' Checklist

💳 Financial & UPI Safety

- **UPI Pin is for Paying, Not Receiving:** Never enter your UPI PIN to *receive* money. If someone claims you've won a prize or a scholarship and asks you to enter your PIN to "claim" it, it is a scam.
- **Verify the 'Payee' Name:** Before hitting 'Send' on apps like PhonePe, GPay, or Paytm, always double-check the verified merchant name displayed on the screen. Scammers often use QR codes that look official but redirect to personal accounts.

🔐 Account Protection

- **Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA):** Activate 2FA on your university ID, WhatsApp, and social media. Use an authenticator app rather than just SMS to prevent "SIM swapping" attacks.
- **Use a Password Manager:** Avoid using "College@123" or your birthday. Use a manager to generate and store unique, complex passwords for every site you use.

🌐 Browsing & Connectivity

- **Avoid Public Wi-Fi for Banking:** College libraries or cafes often have open Wi-Fi. Never log into your bank account or enter card details while on these networks; use your mobile data instead.
- **Check for HTTPS:** Ensure the URL starts with https:// (the 's' stands for secure) before entering any personal data. This is

crucial when applying for internships or exams on third-party portals.

📱 Device & Social Hygiene

- **Audit App Permissions:** Periodically check which apps have access to your microphone, camera, and contacts. Many "free" photo-editing or loan apps are actually data-harvesting tools.
- **Beware of 'Urgent' Requests:** If a friend or professor messages you on WhatsApp/Instagram asking for immediate money or an OTP because they are in an "emergency," call them directly to verify. Their account may be compromised.

🚨 How to Report Cyber Crime

If you have been scammed or witness suspicious activity, do not hesitate to report it. Timely reporting increases the chances of freezing stolen funds.

- **Online Portal:** cybercrime.gov.in
- **National Helpline: 1930** (Available 24/7)

Pro-Tip: If you lose money to a UPI scam, call **1930** within the "Golden Hour" (the first 2 hours) to maximize the chance of the police blocking the transaction before the thief withdraws it.